ENG509_Glossary

1. **A-head** :An A-head is the kind of head (like T) which allows as its specifier an argument expression but not an adjunct expression. An A-bar head is the kind of head (like C) which allows as its specifier either an argument or an adjunct expression.
2. **A-movement** :Movement from one A-position to another (typically, from a subject or complement position into another subject position).
3. **Acronym** :A word derived by taking the initial letter of all or most words in a string and pronouncing them together,
4. **Allomorph** :a variant form of a morpheme, that is, when a unit of meaning varies in sound without changing the meaning.
5. **Constituent structure** :The constituent structure (or phrase structure, or syntactic structure) of an expression is (a representation of) the set of constituents which the expression contains. Syntactic structure is usually represented in terms of a labelled bracketing or a tree diagram.
6. **Derivation** :the formation of a new word from another word or stem. It typically occurs by the addition of an affix.
7. **Determiner** :A word like the/this/that which is typically used to modify a noun, but which has no descriptive content of its own.
8. **Ditransitive** :A ditransitive structure is a double-object structure like 'She gave me them', where the transitive verb gave has two objects (me and them).
9. **Headedness Principle** :An expression is headed if it has a head. The Headedness Principle specifies that every constituent must be headed (i.e. must have a head). So, for example, an expression like 'fond of fast food' is headed by the adjective fond and so is an adjectival phrase.

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10. **Inflection** :a change in or addition to the form of a word that shows a change in the way it is used in sentences
11. **Lexeme** :a basic lexical unit of a language consisting of one word or several words, the elements of which do not separately convey the meaning of the whole.
12. **Lexicon** :a lexicon is a language's inventory of lexemes
13. **Morpheme** :a meaningful morphological unit of a language that cannot be further divided (e.g. in, come, -ing, forming incoming
14. **Morphological derivation** :the process of forming a new word from an existing word, often by adding a prefix or suffix
15. **Morphology** :the study of words, how they are formed, and their relationship to other words in the same language
16. **Morphosyntax** :An area of linguistics that deals with the relationship and interactions between morphology (the structure of words) and syntax (the structure of larger utterances, such as phrases and sentences).
17. **Phonology** :the study of how sounds are organized and used in natural languages
18. **Syntax** :the arrangement of words and phrases to create well-formed sentences in a language
19. **Tense** :The inflectional category that indicates the time an event or action took place relative to the time of utterance.
20. **Transitive verb**: A verb that takes a direct object, e.g., writes.
21. **Wh-movement:** Transformation that moves a question word or phrase from a theoretically posited lower position in a sentence to a higher one in question formation.

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22. **Zero-derivation:** A word-formation process that changes the lexical category of a word without changing its phonological shape. Also called conversion.

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